

PayScope Resources

Understand your pay. Compare your options. Make better decisions.

Salary numbers rarely tell the whole story. A higher hourly rate does not always mean more money in your pocket. Taxes, employment type, location, housing, transportation, inflation and everyday expenses can all change the real value of an offer.

The PayScope Resource Center explains the numbers behind salaries, contract rates and cost of living with practical guides, simple definitions and real-world examples.

[Explore Calculators](#) [Explore Tools](#)

Featured Guides

What Is My Salary Really Worth?

Understand how taxes, deductions and location affect your actual take-home pay.

[Read Guide →](#)

Employee vs Contractor: What's the Difference?

Compare taxes, benefits, expenses and risk across employment structures.

[Read Guide →](#)

C2C vs W-2 vs 1099 vs T4

Understand how different structures can make the same hourly rate worth very different amounts.

[Read Guide →](#)

How Much Salary Do You Need to Live Comfortably?

Put salary into context using housing, transportation and local living costs.

[Read Guide →](#)

Money & Work Explained

Confused by T4, W-2, C2C, 1099, bill rate or tax brackets? PayScope explains common salary, tax, employment and contracting terms in simple language, with examples and links to relevant calculators.

■■ Canada

What is a T4?

A Canadian tax slip an employer provides to report employment income and deductions. Example: an employee earning CA\$80,000 receives a T4 showing employment income and applicable deductions.

What is C2C?

Company-to-company contracting. A client pays a contractor's company for services. Example: a client pays a corporation CA\$80/hour; that corporate revenue is not automatically personal take-home pay.

What is C2H?

Contract-to-hire: a person initially works as a contractor, with the possibility of becoming a permanent employee later.

What is an Incorporated Contractor?

A contractor operates through a corporation. Contract revenue belongs to the business, which may have expenses and tax obligations before the owner receives compensation.

What is CPP?

Canada Pension Plan contributions are payroll contributions that generally apply to employment income and help fund future CPP benefits.

What is EI?

Employment Insurance provides qualifying workers with temporary financial assistance in situations covered by the program; employees generally contribute through payroll deductions.

■ United States

What is a W-2?

A W-2 is an employer-provided tax form reporting an employee's wages and applicable tax withholding for the year.

What is a 1099?

1099 is a family of IRS information returns. In everyday work discussions, '1099 worker' commonly refers to an independent contractor, but 1099 is not itself a single employment classification.

W-2 vs 1099

A W-2 generally describes an employee relationship where the employer handles payroll withholding. An independent contractor generally handles their own tax obligations. Benefits, expenses and flexibility can differ.

■ Recruiting & Staffing Terms

Pay Rate

The rate paid to the worker. Example: \$60/hour.

Bill Rate

The rate charged to the client. Example: \$80/hour.

Spread

The difference between bill rate and pay rate. $\$80 - \$60 = \$20/\text{hour}$.

Margin

Spread divided by bill rate. $\$20 \div \$80 = 25\%$.

Markup

Spread divided by the underlying cost/pay rate. $\$20 \div \$60 = 33.3\%$. Markup and margin are different.

■ Tax & Pay Terms

Gross Pay

Pay before deductions.

Net Pay / Take-Home Pay

Money remaining after applicable deductions.

Federal Tax

Tax imposed by the federal/national government.

State Tax

A tax imposed by an individual US state where applicable.

Provincial Tax

Canadian provincial income tax.

Payroll Tax / Contribution

Taxes or statutory contributions associated with payroll.

Tax Bracket

A range of taxable income subject to a particular marginal rate.

Marginal Tax Rate

The rate applied to the next portion of taxable income.

Effective Tax Rate

Total relevant tax divided by the relevant income.

Tax Deduction

An amount that can reduce taxable income when applicable.

Tax Credit

An amount that can reduce tax owed when applicable.

Withholding

Money withheld from a paycheck toward taxes or other required deductions.

■ Financial & Cost-of-Living Terms

Cost of Living

The typical cost of maintaining a particular standard of living in a location.

Purchasing Power

How much goods and services an income can actually buy in a particular location.

Inflation

A general increase in prices over time.

Real Income

Income considered after adjusting for inflation.

Disposable Income

Money available after relevant taxes and required deductions/expenses, depending on the definition used.

Rent-to-Income Ratio

The share of income allocated to rent.

Salary & Pay

- Salary vs Take-Home Pay
- Gross Pay vs Net Pay
- Hourly to Annual Salary
- Annual Salary to Hourly Rate
- Effective Hourly Rate
- How Much Is \$50 an Hour a Year?
- How Much Is \$60 an Hour a Year?
- How Much Salary Do I Need?

[Explore Salary Calculators →](#)

Taxes & Take-Home Pay

- US Tax Basics
- Canadian Tax Basics
- Federal vs State Tax
- Federal vs Provincial Tax
- CPP & EI Explained
- Payroll Taxes Explained
- Tax Brackets Explained
- Why Is My Take-Home Pay Lower Than My Salary?

[Calculate Take-Home Pay →](#)

Contracting & Employment

- W-2 vs 1099

- T4 vs Contractor
- C2C Explained
- C2C vs T4
- C2H Explained
- Incorporated Contractor Explained
- Contractor vs Employee
- Contract Rate vs Salary

[Compare Employment & Contract Rates →](#)

Recruiter & Staffing Resources

- Bill Rate vs Pay Rate
- Staffing Markup vs Margin
- Recruiter Margin Explained
- Contractor Bill Rate Calculator Guide
- Employer Cost vs Worker Pay
- How Staffing Agency Margins Work

[Open Rate Analysis →](#)

Cost of Living

- Cost of Living by City
- Salary vs Cost of Living
- Rent vs Income
- How Much Income Do I Need to Live in...?
- Purchasing Power Explained
- Cost of Living Comparison

[Compare Cost of Living →](#)

Housing

- Average Rent by City
- Average Rent by Neighborhood
- 1-Bedroom Rent
- 2-Bedroom Rent
- House Prices by City
- Rent Affordability
- Housing vs Take-Home Pay

[Explore Housing Data →](#)

Fuel & Commute

- Fuel Cost Calculator
- Commute Cost Calculator
- Fuel Cost as a Percentage of Income
- Gas Prices by City
- Cost of Driving to Work

[Calculate Commute Costs →](#)

Relocation

- City vs City Salary Comparison
- Salary Equivalent Calculator
- Cost of Living Relocation Calculator
- Moving for a Higher Salary
- Salary Needed to Maintain Your Lifestyle
- Best Cities for Your Salary

[Compare Cities →](#)

City Guides

Explore salary, taxes, housing, fuel and cost-of-living information by location.

Region	Example coverage
■■ United States	New York · Austin · Los Angeles · Dallas · Chicago · Houston
■■ Canada	Toronto · Vancouver · Calgary · Montreal · Ottawa
■■ Mexico	Major cities — salary · cost of living · housing · fuel
■■ Brazil	Major cities — salary · cost of living · housing · fuel

Latest Resources

- What Is CA\$60 an Hour After Tax in Ontario?
- T4 vs C2C: Which Is Better for Contractors?
- How Much Do You Need to Earn to Live in Toronto?
- \$100K Salary in Austin: Take-Home Pay & Cost of Living
- How Much Does a 30-Minute Commute Really Cost?
- What Is a Good Contractor Rate in Canada?

Each resource card can display category, reading time, and published/updated date.

PayScope Data

PayScope uses tax, economic, housing, fuel and market information from relevant public and third-party data sources. Because financial and market data changes, data-driven sections should display the source, data period and last updated date.

PayScope should not describe estimates as guaranteed results. If a data point is unavailable, the interface should clearly state that it is unavailable or that a regional estimate is being used rather than silently substituting another location.

Important Disclaimer

PayScope provides estimates and educational information for general informational purposes. Tax calculations, take-home estimates, housing costs, income benchmarks, fuel prices and other figures may vary based on location, tax year, employment structure, deductions, benefits, market conditions and individual circumstances.

For incorporated contractors and C2C arrangements, contract revenue should not automatically be treated as personal income or take-home pay.

PayScope is not a tax advisor, accountant, lawyer, financial advisor or employment advisor. Consult an appropriately qualified professional for advice specific to your circumstances.

Can't Find What You're Looking For?

Start with a calculator. Enter your location, employment type and salary or contract rate to see what your income could actually look like after taxes and local costs.

[Calculate My Income →](#)

SEO & Content Architecture

Main page: /resources

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- /resources/glossary/what-is-staffing-margin
- /resources/glossary/what-is-tax-bracket
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SEO title: Resources | Salary, Tax, Contractor & Cost of Living Guides | PayScope

Meta description: Explore PayScope guides covering salary, take-home pay, taxes, contractor rates, C2C, recruiting, cost of living, housing, fuel, commuting and relocation.

PayScope — Know what your income is really worth.